Screen Readers

NVDA is a free and open source screen reader for Windows. It converts text on the screen into speech or braille output. Many blind users rely on it every day for web browsing and document reading across applications.

Speech Rate

Beginners usually prefer a slower speech rate of about 150 words per minute. Experienced users often listen at more than 300 words per minute without losing comprehension of the content.

Visual Contrast

Text should have a contrast ratio of at least 4.5 to 1 against its background. Large text needs a ratio of at least 3 to 1 under the common accessibility guidelines for the web.

Braille Displays

A refreshable braille display raises and lowers small pins to form braille cells. Devices usually offer between 14 and 80 cells and connect over USB or Bluetooth.

Keyboard Navigation

Screen reader users rely entirely on keyboard shortcuts to navigate headings, landmarks, lists, and tables without using a mouse.